

History

(A Level, AQA)

Our students will understand that History is a constructed narrative, dependent on perspective and can be contested, while also understanding that within this one can strive for truth and identify falsehood through gaining knowledge and interrogating sources. Importantly we guide and support students to combine all of these skills together and to develop a strong line of argument and well supported judgement within their essays. Through our teaching Backwell students will develop into critically informed citizens. The ability to think and work independently is essential to success at A Level and students will be expected to undertake extensive reading to support their studies. In History teachers and students work together as a team, with a mixture of teacher led sessions and seminar work where pupils become the masters of specific topics and take responsibility to teach one another. Our approach ensures students always feel well supported by their teachers, but are also empowered to develop individual autonomy over their learning.

Entry Requirements:

Grade 5 in GCSE History.

Units	%	When?	Content
Unit 1C: The Tudors: England, 1485–1603	40%	May Year 13	Breadth Study This option allows students to study in breadth issues of change, continuity, cause and consequence in this period through the following key questions: How effectively did the Tudors restore and develop the powers of the monarchy? In what ways and how effectively was England governed during this period? How did relations with foreign powers change and how was the succession secured? How did English society and economy change and with what effects? How far did intellectual and religious ideas change and develop and with what effects? How important was the role of key individuals and groups and how were they affected by developments?
Unit 2L: Italy and Fascism c.1900-1945	40%	June Year 13	Depth Study This option provides for the study in depth of a period of Italian history during which democracy gave way to Fascism. It requires an exploration of concepts such as liberalism, extremism, Fascism and authority. It also encourages students to reflect on the reasons for political change, the interaction of economic and governmental developments and the factors which promote and sustain dictatorship.
Unit 3: Personal Study: The Holocaust	20%	March Year 13	Historical Investigation A personal study based on the Holocaust. Students will be able to choose which question they investigate and will focus on the arguments made by historians about the Holocaust.

Career Links

People sometimes think “You can’t do anything with History”. In fact, nothing could be further from the truth. Good historians have the ability to read, understand and process a lot of information quickly in order to produce confident, concise, articulate and rational judgements. They ask searching and pertinent questions and are not easily fobbed off. As a result, they are highly sought after in a number of occupations: broadcasting, journalism and the legal profession for example. Some of us just prefer to teach!

For more information please contact Mrs Butler.

